

Input and output

Programs interact with users through input and output. Information can be input into a program using a keyboard. Output is shown as information printed on the screen.

SEE ALSO

◀ **100–101** Program flow

◀ **110–111** Types of data

Loops **122–123** ▶
in Python

Input

The “input()” function is used to accept input from the keyboard into a program. It waits until the user finishes typing and presses the “return” or “Enter” key.

1 Using input

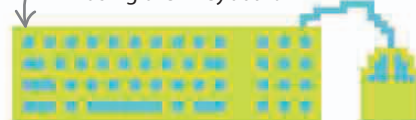
A program can prompt the user what to type. The message is put inside the brackets of “input()”.

```
name = input('Enter your name: ')
print('Hello', name)
```

Adding a space after the colon makes the output look tidier

What the program outputs depends on what name the user types

The “input()” function allows users to interact with a program using their keyboard



2 Output in the shell window

When the program is run, the message “Enter your name:” and its response appear in the shell window.

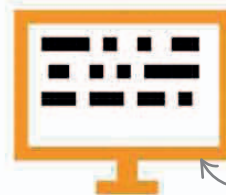
```
Enter your name: Jina
Hello Jina
```

Program outputs message

User types in their name

Output

The “print()” function is used to display characters in the shell window. It can be used to show a combination of text and variables.



Output is displayed on the screen

1 Create some variables

Set up three variables for this simple experiment. Two are strings and one is an integer (whole number).

```
>>> a = 'Dave'
>>> b = 'is'
>>> c = 12
```

Quote marks show these are strings

No quote marks as this is an integer

2 Using the “print()” function

You can put several items inside the brackets of the “print()” function. You can combine variables of different types, and even combine strings and variables.

```
>>> print(a, b, c)
Dave is 12
>>> print('Goodbye', a)
Goodbye Dave
```

Comma separates the different items